

# Is There a Problem Drinker in the Workplace?



ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS® is a fellowship of people who share their experience, strength and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism.

The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership; we are self-supporting through our own contributions.

A.A. is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization or institution; does not wish to engage in any controversy; neither endorses nor opposes any causes.

Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety.

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**M**any organizations — corporations, unions and governmental agencies — have established programs to work with employees whose personal problems have affected their job performance and their families.

Labor and management are increasingly aware of the disease of alcoholism and its high financial and human costs, and recognize the benefits of helping their employees.

***To employers, supervisors  
and personnel professionals***

Alcoholics Anonymous can make available to labor, management, medical, social services, human resources and employee assistance program professionals the cumulative experience of more than two million recovered alcoholics now living comfortable and productive lives without alcohol. A.A. is available in virtually every community with more than 69,000 groups in the United States and Canada alone.

A.A. can help organizations, corporations and businesses, regardless of size, contact men and women who have achieved sobriety, and are willing to share their experience freely with anyone who seeks help.

The A.A. Fellowship is nonprofessional and available at no cost; its primary purpose is the personal recovery and continued sobriety of those alcoholics who turn to it for help. The A.A. approach is based on the ability of recovered alcoholics to help those who are still drinking.

### ***Singleness of purpose and problems other than alcohol***

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as “substance abuse” or “chemical dependency.” Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend *open* A.A. meetings as observers, but only those with a drinking problem may attend *closed* A.A. meetings.

### ***To co-workers***

If you have a co-worker who may be a problem drinker, your understanding of the nature of the problem can play a vital part in helping the drinker to achieve and maintain sobriety.

You can take some action to assist in recovery by developing an understanding of the A.A. program.\* You may want to speak with an A.A. member or read some A.A. literature, which explains our program of recovery and gives a general idea of how A.A. works.

\*You may also want to contact Al-Anon Family Groups. Though it is entirely separate from Alcoholics Anonymous, it uses the general principles of the A.A. program as a guide for husbands, wives, relatives, friends and others close to alcoholics. (Al-Anon’s website: [al-anon.org](http://al-anon.org))

### ***A.A. welcomes any opportunity to:***

1. Meet with any employer to discuss ways A.A. can cooperate.
2. Conduct employee meetings to explain the A.A. program of recovery.
3. Take employees with a drinking problem to A.A. meetings.

### ***How to contact A.A.***

Search for A.A. or Alcoholics Anonymous online, or in your local telephone directory. If A.A. is not listed, please write to the General Service Office, Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163, or visit GSO’s A.A. website: [aa.org](http://aa.org).

## Recommended A.A. Reading

### *A.A. CONFERENCE-APPROVED LITERATURE:*

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THIS IS A.A.

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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS ABOUT A.A.

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IS A.A. FOR YOU?

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YOUNG PEOPLE IN A.A.

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WOMEN IN A.A.

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LGBTQ ALCOHOLICS IN A.A.

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BLACK IN A.A.

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A.A. FOR THE OLDER ALCOHOLIC — NEVER TOO LATE

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ACCESS TO A.A.: MEMBERS SHARE ON OVERCOMING BARRIERS

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A.A. FOR ALCOHOLICS WITH MENTAL HEALTH ISSUES

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THE “GOD” WORD: AGNOSTIC AND ATHEIST MEMBERS IN A.A.

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MANY PATHS TO SPIRITUALITY

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THE A.A. MEMBER — MEDICATIONS AND OTHER DRUGS

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DO YOU THINK YOU’RE DIFFERENT?

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QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS ON SPONSORSHIP

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IS THERE AN ALCOHOLIC IN YOUR LIFE?

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IF YOU ARE A PROFESSIONAL

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HOW A.A. MEMBERS COOPERATE WITH PROFESSIONALS

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A.A. IN YOUR COMMUNITY

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UNDERSTANDING ANONYMITY

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A.A. AS A RESOURCE FOR THE HEALTH CARE PROFESSIONAL

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### *PERIODICALS:*

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ABOUT A.A. (newsletter for helping professionals)

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AA GRAPEVINE (the international monthly journal of A.A.)

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LA VIÑA (bimonthly, in Spanish)

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For additional information, visit [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org)  
(Information for Professionals) or contact the Cooperation  
with the Professional Community desk at the  
General Service Office: [cpc@aa.org](mailto:cpc@aa.org) or 212-870-3400.

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